Game Store Application Using the RAD Model

Introduction

This documentation outlines the development of a game store application using the Rapid Application Development (RAD) model. RAD emphasizes iterative development, quick prototyping, and user feedback, making it ideal for building interactive and user-friendly digital storefronts. The project progresses through four primary phases: Requirements Planning, User Design, Construction, and Cutover, with each phase contributing to a complete and functional game store platform.

Phase 1: Requirements Planning

This phase focuses on gathering business requirements and defining the application's core functionalities.

Objectives:

- Understand the expectations of gamers and game vendors.
- Define essential features of the game store platform.

Key Features Identified:
Navigation:
Home, Category, Game Listings, Game Details, Cart, Order Confirmation.

User Actions:
Browsing games, Searching by categories, Adding games to cart, Completing purchases.

Use Cases:

- User Story 1: As a user, I want to browse and search for games by category and genre.
- User Story 2: As a user, I want to add selected games to the cart and complete the purchase securely.
- User Story 3: As a user, I want to view my order history and track the status of purchases.

Functional Requirements:

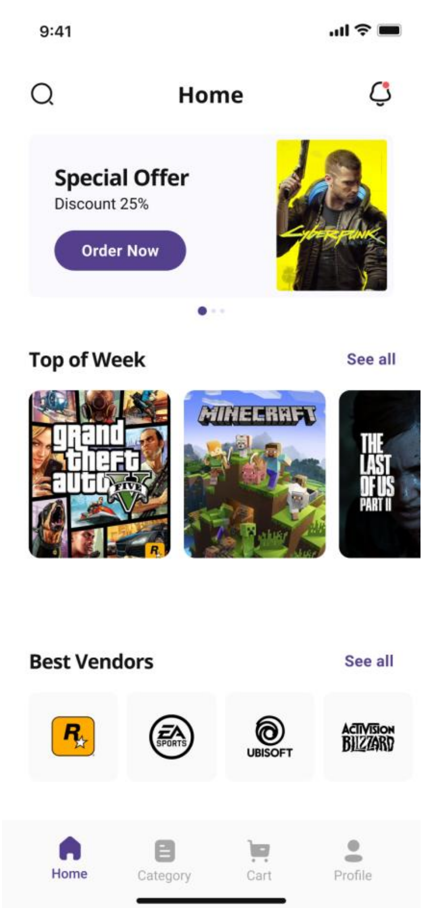
- Secure user login and profile management
- Game browsing by category (e.g., Action, Adventure, Sports, Role-Play)
- Cart management and real-time updates
- Payment simulation and order generation
- Order confirmation and status tracking

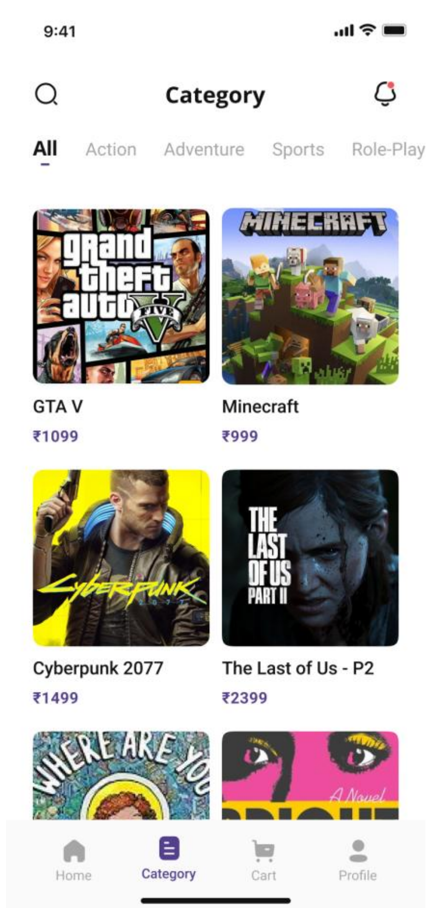
Phase 2: User Design

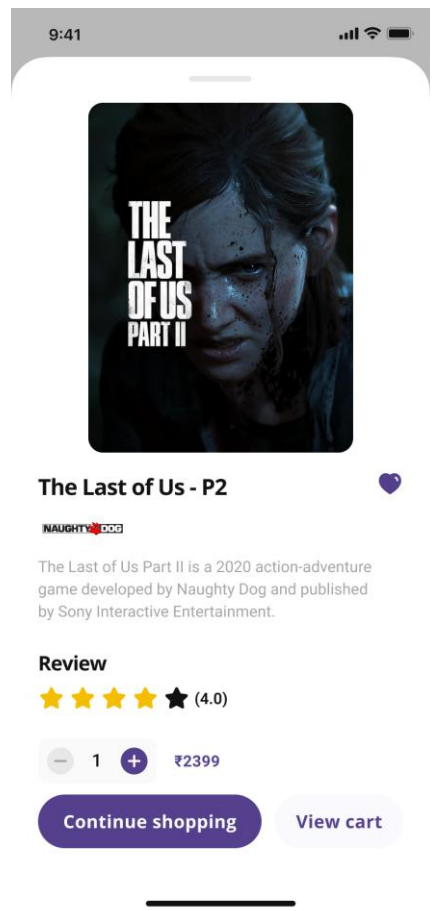
This phase is centered on the design and prototyping of the user interface, focusing on usability and visual engagement.

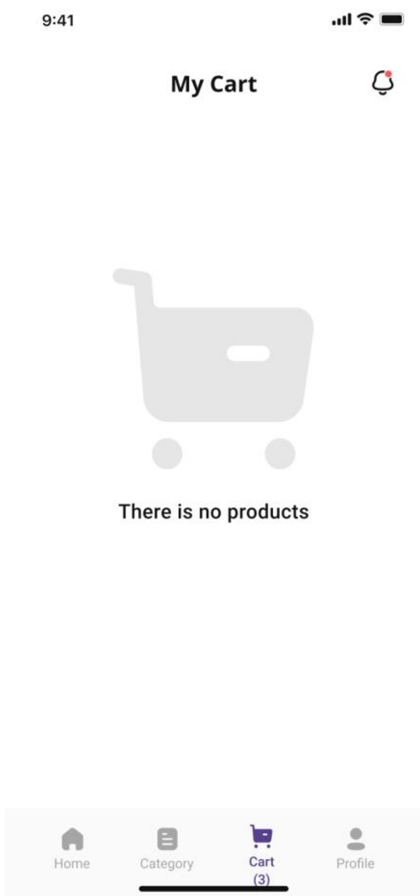
Tools Used:
- Axure RP: For wireframing and interactive prototyping.

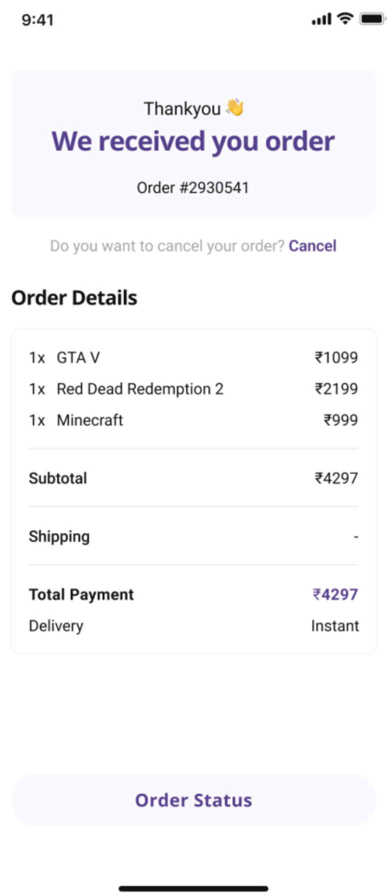
Wireframe Design:
Screens designed include:
- Home Screen (special offers, top games, best vendors)
- Category Screen (games sorted by genre)
- Game Details Page (description, rating, price, add to cart)
- Cart Page (cart contents and checkout flow)
- Order Confirmation Page (order summary and status)











User Feedback:

Initial prototypes were shared with target users. Feedback was collected and incorporated to:

- Highlight game ratings and reviews more clearly
- Simplify cart interactions
- Improve readability of game details
- Make navigation tabs easily accessible at the bottom

Phase 3: Construction

This phase involves turning the prototype into a fully interactive interface.

Prototype Development:

- Wireframes enhanced with realistic transitions and button interactions.
- Integrated dynamic data behavior such as cart item count and subtotal updates.

Iterative Testing:

- Usability testing through Axure’s preview.
- Tested navigation flow, category filtering, and cart operations.

Refinement:

- Added instant feedback on adding games to cart.
- Optimized order details layout.
- Improved consistency in visual style across screens.

Phase 4: Cutover

The final phase ensures deployment readiness and prepares end-users.

Activities:

- Final bug fixes and design polish.
- Prepared project files for development handoff.
- Collected final feedback from users for minor refinements.

Conclusion

By following the RAD model, the development of the game store application maintained a strong focus on user experience and fast feedback cycles. The use of Figma enabled quick prototyping and effective communication of design ideas, ultimately resulting in a user-centric and visually appealing game store platform. This project demonstrates the effectiveness of RAD in building engaging and efficient digital storefronts for gamers.